Jiacheng (Karcen) Zheng

MPhil Student in Applied Economics
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Research Interests

Primary fields	Econometrics; Causal Inference; Health Economics
Methods	Data Science in Economics; Machine Learning / Natural Language Processing; Input–Output and Network Analysis; Global Value Chains
Other interests	Regional Economics; Poverty; Behavioral Economics; fMRI

Education

Tianjin University *Sep 2026–Jun 2029 (expected)*

MPhil in Applied Economics, Ma Yinchu School of Economics

- Advisor: Asst. Prof. Shenshen Yang
- Research themes: theoretical econometrics, causal inference, missing data, public health policy
- Honored to be Prof. Yang's first graduate student

Shandong University *Sep 2022–Jun 2026*

B.Eng. in Bioengineering, Marine College

- GPA: 86.24/100; rank 5/50 (top 10%); **Outstanding Graduate**
- Dual-degree track in *International Politics & International Economics and Trade*, School of Northeast Asian Studies (2022–2023)
- **Thesis:** *Is More Complexity Always Better? Hepatotoxicity Prediction of Marine Natural Products with* in vivo *Validation in* Danio rerio; ranked first in the thesis defense group

Dalian University of Technology *Sep 2019–Mar 2021*

Chemical Engineering coursework, School of Chemistry

- GPA: 88/100 (top 7.4% of cohort); withdrew in 2021 to retake the Gaokao (National College Entrance Examination)

Selected quantitative coursework: Calculus I (98%), Calculus II (92%), Linear Algebra (90%), Probability and Statistics (88%), University Physics I: Mechanics, Special Relativity, and Optics (98%), University Physics II: Electricity and Magnetism; Introductory Quantum Mechanics (100%).

Publications

Peer-Reviewed Articles and Conference Papers

1. Khan, J., **Zheng, J.**, Ahmad, M., & Khan, Z. A. "Agglomeration Economies and Inequality: Theory and Evidence from Provincial China." *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*, **24**(2), 317–340, 2025. doi:10.1080/14765284.2025.2538328
2. You, P., Chen, A., Feng, Q., Hou, J., **Zheng, J.**, & Chen, H. "Integrative Bioinformatics Prioritizes the *TLR4* Axis and Candidate Non-Starch Polysaccharides in Hyperuricemia-Associated Inflammation." *Biology*, **15**, 1150, 2026. doi:10.3390/biology15141150
3. Chen, B., Hong, D., Ji, J., **Zheng, J.**, Dong, B., Zhou, J., Wang, K., Dai, J., Wang, X., Chen, W., Zheng, Q., Li, W., Han, S., Guo, Y., & Yang, Y. "InterMT: Multi-Turn Interleaved Preference Alignment with Human Feedback." *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* (*NeurIPS 2025*), **Spotlight**. Project page

Translation and Acknowledged Scholarly Contributions

- Crescenzi, R., & Rodríguez-Pose, A. *Innovation and Regional Growth in the European Union* (Chinese edition; translated by Jianhui Ren et al.). Beijing Economic Management Press, 2024. Contributing translator of

Chapter 3, "Geographical Accessibility and Human Capital Accumulation." The book received the Third Prize in the "Hundred Works" Project for Outstanding Achievements in Social Science Research, Shanxi Province.

- Khan, J., Li, Y., & Mahsud, Q. J. "Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018: A Network and Input–Output Approach." *Structural Change and Economic Dynamics*, **70**, 33–44, 2024. doi:10.1016/j.strueco.2023.12.017. Acknowledged for data analysis and visualization.
- Li, Y., & Khan, J. *Wind from the East: How Does the Belt and Road Initiative Connect Continents to Unleash Economic Potential?* Peter Lang. doi:10.3726/b22199. Contribution acknowledged in the volume.

Research and Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant *Sep 2026–Present*

Advanced Macroeconomics I (graduate level), Institute of Blue and Green Development, Shandong University *Remote*

- Prepare tutorial materials and problem sets; answer student questions on macroeconomic theory and quantitative methods
- Support assignment grading and course administration

Research Assistant *Sep 2025–Present*

Ma Yinchu School of Economics & College of Management and Economics (CoME), Tianjin University *On-site*

- Conduct research in health economics and financial economics on two projects funded by the National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC)

Research Intern *Feb–May 2025*

Big Data Institute, HKUST & Hong Kong Generative AI R&D Center (HKGAI) *Remote*

- Conducted data-driven research on preference alignment for multi-turn, multimodal large language models
- Collaborated with Peking University researchers (J. Ji, B. Chen, et al.); the resulting paper was accepted as a *NeurIPS 2025 Spotlight*

Research Assistant *Jul–Aug 2024*

The Bartlett School of Sustainable Construction, University College London *Remote*

- PI: Prof. Zhifu Mi. Contributed to citation-network analysis of the IPCC Sixth Assessment Report (Working Group II), including reference-database construction and analysis pipelines

Research Assistant *Mar 2023–Mar 2025*

Regional and Country-Specific Data Analytics Center, Institute of International Studies, Shandong University *On-site*

- PIs: Prof. Yuan Li and Dr. Jamal Khan. Helped build the center's data infrastructure; supported programming, data visualization, and academic writing
- Worked on input–output analysis, global value chains, and machine learning, deep learning, and NLP methods for data-driven economic modeling

Conference Presentations

31st International Input–Output Association Conference, Malé *2025*

Accepted for oral presentation (withdrawn for health reasons): "Linkages and Structural Changes in the Chinese Financial Sector, 1996–2018."

10th International Workshop on RUSE in China, Peking University *2023*

Oral presentation: "Agglomeration Economies and Regional Inequality in Provincial China."

Honors, Awards, and Distinctions

Outstanding Graduate, Shandong University	2026
National Encouragement Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China	2023, 2025
Merit Scholarship (Level III), Shandong University	2023, 2025
Travel Grant, International Input–Output Association (US$3,000; COMPASS program)	2025
Invited Delegate, PwC Open Day, PwC Jinan	2023
National Scholarship, Ministry of Education, P.R. China	2020
Outstanding Student Scholarship (Level II), Dalian University of Technology	2020
Outstanding Youth League Member & Spiritual Civilization Scholarship, DUT	2020

Recommended (exam-exempt) graduate admission offers: Peking University (Institute of New Structural Economics); Xiamen University (WISE); Renmin University of China (School of Applied Economics); Shanghai University of Finance and Economics (School of Economics); Tianjin University (Ma Yinchu School of Economics).

Selected Projects and Open-Source Tools

Citation Audit Toolkit · GVC–WWZ Explorer · TableLab DeepSeek · CEJ Skills · IPCC Literature Database · LaTeX Cookbook · Scaffold OOD Generalization · TransProof · CEA WeChat Writer · Brain Analyzer V3.0 · ElderAI Survey Platform · SDU Thesis Template · TikZ Atelier · Mostly Harmless Econometrics · Align Anything · Journal of Love LaTeX Template

iTooth — A Digital Platform for Community Oral Health (Team Leader). 13th National University E-commerce "Innovation, Creativity & Entrepreneurship" Challenge, 2022. *Second Prize*, Shandong University round.

Academic Service and Affiliations

Ad hoc referee: *Journal of Chinese Economic and Business Studies*, *Journal of Digital Economy*, *Finance Research Letters*

- Chinese Economic Association UK/Europe (CEA), student member, 2026–Present
- International Input–Output Association (IIOA), member, 2025–2026
- Chinese Society of Optimization, Systems Engineering & Economic Mathematics, member, 2023–2024
- Beijing Society of Image and Graphics, member, 2023–2024

Outreach, Leadership, and Professional Experience

Chinese Economic Association UK/Europe (CEA) *2026–Present*
Communications Volunteer *Remote*
- Release news updates, compose academic paper interpretations, and maintain the association's official website

Structural Change and Economic Dynamics *2023–2025*
Volunteer, WeChat Official Account *Remote*
- Published news posts and wrote paper interpretations for the journal's WeChat Official Account

Tian Village University Social Practice Project *2025–2026*
Community Outreach Lead — volunteer and community engagement *On-site*
- Lead after-school tutoring and science outreach for rural primary and middle-school students
- Organize community first-aid training (CPR, Heimlich maneuver) and public-health awareness campaigns

Teach for China (Bilibili) *2023*
Volunteer Teacher *Remote*
- Produced popular-science course videos for primary and middle-school students in rural and underserved communities to support educational access and equity

Golden Education *Summer 2023*

Marketing Management Trainee (*mentor: Jihai Zhao*) *On-site*

– Planned and executed campus branding campaigns; supported social media operations and expanded campus outreach

Vice President, "Shanhai" Political Observation Club, Shandong University *2024–2025*

Director of External Relations, "Shanhai" Political Observation Club, Shandong University *2023–2024*

Secretary, Department of Student Rights and Mental Health, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Shandong University *2022–2023*

Residence Hall Council Chair, Dalian University of Technology *2019–2021*

Deputy Director, New Media, "Yin Ji Guang Ying" New Media Studio, Dalian University of Technology *2019–2021*

Deputy Director, Culture and Arts, School of Chemistry, Dalian University of Technology *2019–2020*

Technical Skills

Programming	Python; R; Stata; MATLAB
Software & tools	SPSS; Orange 3; Git / GitHub; LaTeX; Microsoft Office; Adobe Creative Suite
Languages	Chinese (native); English (IELTS 7.0, 2021)

References available upon request. Last updated: November 9, 2026